

Qroo Spanish Crew

Conjugating Verbs in the Present Tense

Introduction

The present tense in Spanish is used to express actions happening right now, habitual actions, and even some future actions. In this guide, we will start with regular verbs, explaining the breakdown of -AR, -ER, and -IR endings. Then, we will cover irregular verbs and group them by similar patterns, with a more complete section on common irregular verbs.

Regular Verbs

Regular verbs in Spanish follow predictable patterns based on their infinitive endings: **-AR**, **-ER**, and **-IR**. Here's how to conjugate them in the present tense:

Conjugation Endings for Regular Verbs

Subject Pronoun	-AR Ending	-ER Ending	-IR Ending
yo	-o	-o	-o
tú	-as	-es	-es
él/ella/usted	-a	-e	-e
nosotros/nosotras	-amos	-emos	-imos
vosotros/vosotras (Spain only)	-áis	-éis	-ís
ellos/ellas/ustedes	-an	-en	-en

Examples of Regular Verbs

-AR Verbs

- **Hablar (to speak):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	hablo
tú	hablas
él/ella/usted	habla
nosotros	hablamos
vosotros	habláis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	hablan

-ER Verbs

- **Comer (to eat):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	como
tú	comes
él/ella/usted	come
nosotros	comemos
vosotros	coméis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	comen

-IR Verbs

- **Vivir (to live):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	vivo
tú	vives
él/ella/usted	vive
nosotros	vivimos
vosotros	vivís
ellos/ellas/ustedes	viven

Irregular Verbs

While regular verbs follow the patterns shown above, irregular verbs can deviate in different ways. Below, these verbs are grouped by their similarities and presented in more detail.

Verbs Irregular in the First-Person Singular ("Yo")

Some verbs are irregular only in the "yo" form, but are regular in other conjugations.

hacer	hago	hago, haces, hace, hacemos, hacéis, hacen
poner	pongo	pongo, pones, pone, ponemos, ponéis, ponen
salir	salgo	salgo, sales, sale, salimos, salís, salen
traer	traigo	traigo, traes, trae, traemos, traéis, traen
valer	valgo	valgo, vales, vale, valemós, valéis, valen
saber	sé	sé, sabes, sabe, sabemos, sabéis, saben
ver	veo	veo, ves, ve, vemos, veis, ven

Verbs with Stem Changes

Some verbs change their stem vowels in all forms except **nosotros** and **vosotros**. These changes are categorized as **e > ie**, **o > ue**, or **e > i**.

e > ie

querer	quiero, quieres, quiere, queremos, queréis, quieren
pensar	pienso, piensas, piensa, pensamos, pensáis, piensan
entender	entiendo, entiendes, entiende, entendemos, entendéis, entienden

o > ue

poder	puedo, puedes, puede, podemos, podéis, pueden
volver	vuelvo, vuelves, vuelve, volvemos, volvéis, vuelven
dormir	duermo, duermes, duerme, dormimos, dormís, duermen

e > i

pedir	pido, pides, pide, pedimos, pedís, piden
servir	sirvo, sirves, sirve, servimos, servís, sirven

Verbs with Irregular Stems

Certain verbs have unique stem changes across all forms:

tener	tengo, tienes, tiene, tenemos, tenéis, tienen
venir	vengo, vienes, viene, venimos, venís, vienen
decir	digo, dices, dice, decimos, decís, dicen

Completely Irregular Verbs

A small group of verbs have completely irregular conjugations that must be memorized.

ser	soy, eres, es, somos, sois, son
estar	estoy, estás, está, estamos, estáis, están
ir	voy, vas, va, vamos, vais, van
haber	he, has, ha, hemos, habéis, han

Summary

Irregular verbs in the present tense often follow specific patterns, such as changes only in the "yo" form, stem changes, or complete irregularity. This section provides detailed conjugations for the most common irregular verbs, giving a clear overview of their patterns. Practice with these verbs is key to mastering the present tense in Spanish.